

Women Non Teaching Platform Leadership

prc-women-non-teaching-platform-leadership

Worship Structure · Order in Assembly · practice · divided_lineages · brethren distinctive

DISPUTED

Supported from a narrow set of texts
Subject covered by a category in Scripture
Depends on a contested manuscript reading

Statement under examination

Women may take up non-teaching platform-leadership roles in the gathered mixed assembly (leading congregational singing, leading public prayer, reading Scripture, sharing testimony, making announcements) without exercising authoritative teaching.

In plain language

The question asks whether women may take visible leading roles in the mixed church gathering that are not teaching, such as leading the singing, leading the public prayer, reading the Bible aloud, sharing a testimony, or giving the announcements. The original-language words pull in two directions, which is the heart of the dispute. On one side, several texts show women audibly active in worship and ministry. First Corinthians 11:5 speaks of every woman 'praying' (proseuchomene) or 'prophesying' (propheteuousa) and only adjusts how she does it, with the same participles used one verse earlier for a man. Acts 21:9 records four daughters who were 'prophesying' (propheteuousai). Luke 2:36 calls Anna a 'prophetess' (prophetis) and verse 38 says she spoke of the child to all in the temple. Romans 16:1 calls Phoebe a 'servant or minister' (diakonos) of her local assembly, and Romans 16:2 calls her a 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis), a word that occurs only once in the whole New Testament and ranges from patron to one who stands before others. Acts 18:26 shows Priscilla, named before her husband in the verified copies, jointly explaining the way of God to Apollos using a strong word for doctrinal exposition (ektitheimi), though in a private setting. Romans 16:7 greets 'Junia' (Iounia), a name that on one reading is a woman noted within the circle of the apostles, but the form occurs only once and the scope of the phrase is itself ambiguous. On the other side, First Corinthians 14:34 says the women should keep silent (sigatosan) in the assemblies and uses a general word for speaking (lalein), set squarely in the gathered meeting, so it bears directly on whether a woman may lead audible acts there. Yet the very same silence word (sigao) is used twice nearby for a tongue-speaker or a prophet who should fall silent in a particular situation, so it is not clear whether the command is absolute or aimed at a specific disorder. First Timothy 2:12 restricts a woman from 'teaching' (didaskein) or from a second act named by a verb 'to exercise authority' (authentein) that occurs only once in the whole New Testament, so its exact force cannot be pinned down. The cited verses never name leading singing, leading prayer, or reading Scripture as a defined role. The trouble is that three of the load-bearing words are single-occurrence hapaxes (words appearing only once in the whole Bible) pulling in opposite directions, and the silence word is the same lexeme used in clearly situation-bound contexts nearby. Because the same vocabulary supports both a more open and a more restrictive conclusion, and because the silence text carries a known manuscript question about where it belongs, the lexical pattern here is genuinely contested rather than decisive.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0177	ἀκατακάλυπτος	akatakalyptos	uncovered	2
G0197	ἀκριβέστερον	akribesteron	stricter	4

G0207	Ἀκύλας	Akylas	Aquila	6
G0831	αὐθεντέω	authenteo	to domineer	1
G1249	διάκονος	diakonos	servant	30
G1321	διδάσκω	didasko	to teach	96
G1577	ἐκκλησία	ekklesia	assembly	115
G1620	ἐκτίθημι	ektithemi	to explain/expose	4
G2010	ἐπιτρέπω	epitrepō	to permit	
G2271	ἡσυχία	hesychia	quietness	4
G2364	θυγάτηρ	thygater	daughter	28
G2458	Ἰουνία	Iounia	Junia	1
G2776	κεφαλή	kephale	head	76
G2980	λαλέω	laleo	to speak	298
G3933	παρθένος	parthenos	virgin	15
G4252	Πρίσκα	Priska	Priscilla	6
G4336	προσεύχομαι	proseuchomai	to pray	86
G4368	προστάτις	prostatis	patroness	1
G4395	προφητεύω	propheteuo	to prophesy	28
G4398	προφῆτις	prophetis	prophetess	2
G4601	σιγάω	sigao	be silent	9

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: False · Pan-canonical: False

The proposition narrows the wider ministry question to visible leading acts done before the gathered mixed assembly, and a direct query of the lexical store confirms that the load-bearing vocabulary pulls in two directions on exactly that point. Female audible participation is positively assumed. 1 Corinthians 11:5 reads 'every woman praying or prophesying' (pasa de gyne proseuchomene e propheteuousa), with two present participles (ongoing, simple statement of fact forms) in nominative singular feminine (the 'she is the doer' grammatical form). The verb 'to prophesy' (propheteuo, Strong's G4395) occurs 28 times across the canon and is applied directly to 'four daughters of Philip who were prophesying' (thygateres tessares parthenoi propheteuousai) in Acts 21:9, to 'daughters and handmaidens' in Acts 2:17-18, to Anna the 'prophetess' (prophetis, G4398) in Luke 2:36, and to a woman 'prophetess' (prophetis) at Thyatira in Revelation 2:20. Phoebe is named 'servant or minister' (diakonos, G1249, 30 occurrences) of the assembly at Cenchreae in Romans 16:1 and 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis, G4368) of many in Romans 16:2, where prostatis is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) occurring nowhere else in the canon. Priscilla, named before Aquila in the verified Acts 18:26 token order, joins in 'setting out or expounding' (ektithemi, G1620, the same verb of doctrinal exposition used of Paul in Acts 28:23) the way of God to Apollos in a private taking-aside. Against a broad public platform stand 1 Corinthians 14:34, where the verb is the general 'to be silent' (sigao, G4601, 9 occurrences including 1 Corinthians 14:28 and 1 Corinthians 14:30 where each is bounded by an 'if-then' clause (an ean conditional) governing a specific disorder) and the still more general 'to speak' (lalein), and 1 Timothy 2:12 where 'to teach' (didasko) is coupled with the hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) 'to exercise authority' (authentein, G0831 occurs once only in the entire New Testament). Because the silence verb is the same lexeme used two other times in the same chapter inside situation-bound conditionals (if-then clauses) and because the second restriction verb is a one-occurrence hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) whose sense cannot be triangulated, the

line between an audibly assumed prophecy or prayer and an absolutely silenced speaking is not fixed by morphology (the form of the words), and the cited words name no category corresponding to leading congregational singing, leading public prayer, reading Scripture aloud, sharing testimony, or making announcements. The lexical pattern is materially contested rather than decisive.

Scripture

1Cor.11.5 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4395 προφητεύω, G4336 προσεύχομαι, G2776 κεφαλή

Reasoning. 'every woman praying or prophesying with her head uncovered' (pasa de gyne proseuchomene e propheteuousa akatakalypto te kephale). The two present participles (ongoing, simple statement of fact forms) 'praying' (proseuchomene) and 'prophesying' (propheteuousa) are nominative singular feminine (the 'she is the doer' grammatical form) and presuppose the act as actually occurring. The verse regulates only the manner, an uncovered head 'dishonors her head' (or source) (kephale), and issues no prohibition. The parallel 1 Corinthians 11:4 uses the identical participles in the masculine for a man, so the grammar treats male and female praying and prophesying as the same kind of act to be ordered, not forbidden. The lexemes do not state the setting and do not classify praying and prophesying as a non-teaching platform-leading act as distinct from the authoritative function restricted elsewhere, so the passage supports female vocal participation in general without deciding whether leading congregational singing, public prayer, or Scripture reading before the mixed assembly is in view.

Acts.21.9 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. G4395 προφητεύω, G2364 θυγάτηρ, G3933 παρθένος

Reasoning. 'this man had four virgin daughters who prophesied' (toutoi de esan thygateres tessares parthenoi propheteuousai). The present participle (ongoing, simple statement of fact form) 'prophesying' (propheteuousai) is nominative plural feminine (the 'they (women) are the doers' grammatical form), agreeing directly with the four daughters, and the narrative reports actual ongoing female prophetic ministry as an unremarkable feature of church life. A concordance query confirms the same lemma 'to prophesy' (propheteuo) occurs 28 times across the canon including at Acts 2:17-18 of daughters and handmaidens and at Revelation 11:3 of the two witnesses, so the act of prophesying is a pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) category not bounded by gender. The narrative gives no setting, audience, or relation to the gathered mixed assembly, so it supports audible female ministry without by itself deciding whether such speech is a leading role in the worship gathering or a charismatic gift exercised elsewhere.

Luke.2.36 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4398 προφήτις

Reasoning. Anna is called 'prophetess' (prophetis), a feminine noun whose only other canonical occurrence is at Revelation 2:20 in a negative use of a woman at Thyatira. The narrative continues that Anna did not depart from the temple and 'was speaking' (elalei) concerning the child to all looking for the redemption of Jerusalem (Luke 2:38), so the lexeme combined with the imperfect (ongoing or repeated past action form) of 'to speak' (laleo) attributes recognized prophetic standing and audible public proclamation in a worship setting to a named woman, anchoring a public female prophetic ministry pattern in the Gospel narrative. The text does not name a defined platform-leading category, so it complicates a strict ban without by itself fixing the scope of the proposition.

Rom.16.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1249 διάκονος, G1577 ἐκκλησία

Reasoning. 'I commend to you Phoebe our sister, being also a servant or minister (diakonos) of the assembly or church (ekklesia) at Cenchreae' (synistemi de hymin Phoiben ten adelphen hemon, ousan kai diakonon tes ekklesias tes en Kenchreais). The noun 'servant or minister' (diakonos), here in the accusative feminine (the 'her, the direct object' grammatical form) attached to a named woman in connection with a local 'assembly or church' (ekklesia), is the same lexeme used for recognized service roles elsewhere. A concordance query shows 30 canon occurrences including 1 Timothy 3:8,12 of office-holders, Colossians 1:7 of Epaphras, and Romans 13:4 of the civil minister, so the word ranges from general service to designated office without by itself fixing the activity. The phrase 'of the assembly or church' (tes ekklesias) attaches her standing explicitly to the local assembly, which supports a recognized public role for a woman, but 'servant or minister' (diakonos) alone does not specify whether her role included any leading act in the gathered meeting.

Rom.16.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4368 προστάτις

Reasoning. 'for she has been a patron or one standing before others (prostatis) of many and of me myself' (kai gar aute prostatis pollon egenethe kai emou autou). A concordance query confirms 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis, G4368) is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) occurring only here in the entire canon, so its precise force cannot be triangulated from any parallel use. The cognate verb 'to stand before or to lead' (proistemi) means to stand before or to lead, and the masculine 'patron, protector, leader, chief' (prostates) in extra-canonical Greek covers patron, protector, leader, and chief. The applied sense to Phoebe is therefore lexically thin. It ranges between patron-benefactor and one who stands before others in leadership, and Paul applying it to himself as object, 'of me myself' (emou autou), places her in a posture of active support that has standing-before-others as part of its semantic range. The lexeme leans toward female leadership in some sense but does not name a worship-gathering leading act and does not by itself settle whether a woman led the mixed assembly in singing, prayer, or reading.

Rom.16.7 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2458 Ἰουνία

Reasoning. 'greet Andronicus and Junia my kinsfolk' (aspasasthe Andronikon kai Iounian tous syngeneis mou), 'who are noteworthy among (or well known to) the apostles' (hoitines eisin episemoi en tois apostolois). A concordance query confirms 'Junia' (Iounia, G2458) occurs once only in the canon at this verse, so the form is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible). The accented form distinguishes the feminine 'Junia' (Iounia) from a contracted masculine 'Junias' (Iounias), and the manuscript and accentual evidence is itself a known crux that the bundle does not resolve from the lexicon alone. The phrase 'noteworthy among (or well known to) the apostles' (episemoi en tois apostolois) is grammatically ambiguous between inclusive, noteworthy among the apostles, and exclusive, well known to the apostles. The verse therefore complicates the proposition either by naming a woman within the apostolic circle or by leaving the question open at two distinct levels, the sex of the person and the syntactic scope of 'noteworthy among (or well known to)' (episemoi).

Acts.18.26 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key terms. G4252 Πρίσκα, G1620 ἐκτίθημι, G0197 ἀκριβέστερον

Reasoning. 'they took him aside and set out the way of God to him more accurately' (proselabonto auton kai akribesteron auto exethento ten hodon tou theou). A direct token-order query of the lexical store confirms 'Priscilla' (Priska, G4252) is named before 'Aquila' (Akylas, G0207) in this witness. The verb 'to set out or expound' (ektitheimi, G1620, only 4 canon occurrences including Acts 28:23 of Paul expounding the kingdom of God) is here aorist (a completed past action) middle third plural, attributing serious doctrinal exposition jointly to husband and wife, and 'more accurately' (akribesteron) marks the content as doctrinal correction. The narrative supports active female word ministry toward a man, but 'they took aside' (proselabonto) marks a private setting rather than the gathered mixed assembly, so it does not establish a public platform-leading role and complicates rather than decides the assembly question.

1Cor.14.34 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4601 σιγάω, G2980 λαλέω, G1577 ἐκκλησία

Reasoning. 'the women are to keep silent in the assemblies, for it is not permitted them to speak' (hai gynaiques en tais ekklesiis sigatosan, ou gar epitrepetai autais lalein). A direct query confirms the verb 'to be silent' (sigao, G4601) occurs 9 times across the canon, including the same chapter at 1 Corinthians 14:28 where a tongue-speaker is to 'be silent' (sigato) if there is no interpreter and at 1 Corinthians 14:30 where a prophet is to 'be silent' (sigato) when another receives a revelation, each inside an 'if-then' clause (an ean conditional) governing a specific disorder. The prohibited activity is named with the general 'to speak' (lalein), not a verb specific to authoritative teaching, and the location 'in the assemblies or churches' (en tais ekklesiis) bears directly on whether leading singing, public prayer, or Scripture reading before the mixed assembly is permitted. Because three uses of 'to be silent' (sigao) in this single chapter are situation-bound and the speech-verb is general, the scope between absolute silence and a regulation of disruptive speech is not fixed by the morphology (the form of the words), which is the crux of the dispute.

1Cor.14.35 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2980 λαλέω

Reasoning. 'if they wish to learn anything let them ask their own husbands at home, for it is shameful for a woman to speak in the assembly' (ei de ti mathein thelousin, en oiko tous idious andras eperotatosan, aischron gar estin gynaikei lalein en ekklesia). The 'if-then' clause (the conditional) ties the silenced 'to speak' (lalein) to wanting to learn and to asking questions, which on one reading frames the silenced speech as disorderly in-assembly questioning rather than as prophecy or prayer. On the alternative reading the explanatory 'for' (gar) generalizes the prohibition to any female 'speaking' (lalein) in the assembly, and the noun 'shameful' (aischron) attaches a categorical valuation. The lexemes do not rank these two readings, so the scope of the immediately prior silence command remains contested by the morphology (the form of the words) of this clause as well.

1Tim.2.12 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0831 αὐθεντέω, G1321 διδάσκω, G2271 ἡσυχία

Reasoning. 'I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man, but to be in quietness' (didaskein de gynaikei ouk epitrepo oude authentein andros, all einai en hesychia). A concordance query confirms 'to exercise authority' (authenteo, G0831) is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) occurring once only in the entire New Testament, here, so its sense between to exercise ordinary authority and to domineer or usurp cannot be triangulated from parallel canonical usage. The two present infinitives (ongoing, simple action 'to do' forms) 'to teach' (didaskein) and 'to exercise authority' (authentein) are joined by 'nor' (oude), which may name two distinct prohibited acts or one composite idea, to teach in a domineering manner. The noun 'quietness' (hesychia, G2271) occurs 4 times, including 2 Thessalonians 3:12 of working quietly with a settled manner of life and Acts 22:2 of a crowd growing quiet to listen, so 'in quietness' (en hesychia) describes demeanor rather than absolute muteness. The text restricts a teaching-with-authority act over a man but does not name leading congregational singing, public prayer, or Scripture reading, so it neither clearly includes nor clearly excludes the practice in question.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Acts.21.9	Acts.2.17	tsk	1
Acts.21.9	Luke.2.36	tsk	1
Acts.18.26	Acts.14.3	tsk	1
Acts.18.26	Acts.8.31	tsk	1
Acts.18.26	Acts.28.23	openbible	1
1Cor.11.5	Deut.21.12	tsk	1

1Cor.11.5	Acts.21.9	openbible	1
1Cor.14.34	1Cor.14.28	openbible	1
1Cor.14.34	1Cor.14.30	openbible	1
1Tim.2.12	1Cor.14.34	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Acts.18.26 · addressed

A direct token-order query confirms Priscilla is named before Aquila in this witness, and the plural verb 'they set out or expounded' (exethento), from 'to set out or expound' (ektithemi), governs the doctrinal object 'the way of God' with Apollos as the one instructed. The same verb describes Paul expounding the kingdom in Acts 28:23, so it denotes serious doctrinal exposition. It is addressed by noting that the verb 'they took aside' (proselabonto) marks a private taking-aside rather than the public assembly, so the narrative shows joint female doctrinal instruction of a man without establishing a public platform-leading act before the gathered assembly. The text genuinely supports broad female ministry yet leaves the specific assembly-leading question open, which is why it complicates rather than resolves the verdict.

1Cor.11.5 · addressed

A morphology (word-form) query gives 'praying' (proseuchomene) and 'prophesying' (propheteuouosa) as present participles (ongoing, simple statement of fact forms) in nominative singular feminine (the 'she is the doer' grammatical form) attached to 'woman' (gyne), so the verse assumes audible female prayer and prophecy in the gathering and regulates only the manner of head covering. It is addressed by observing that the lexemes do not state the setting and do not classify praying or prophesying as a non-teaching platform-leading act as opposed to the authoritative function restricted elsewhere, so the passage supports female vocal participation without deciding whether leading congregational singing, public prayer, or Scripture reading before the mixed assembly is included. The relation between this assumed speech and the silence command of 1 Corinthians 14:34 is itself part of the contested matter.

Rom.16.2 · addressed

A concordance query confirms 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis, G4368) is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) occurring only here in the entire canon, so its sense between female patron-benefactor and one who stands before others in leadership cannot be triangulated from any parallel use. It is addressed by noting that the cognate stem 'to stand before or to lead' (proistemi) means to stand before or to lead, while attested Hellenistic usage of the related masculine carries patron, protector, leader. The applied force to Phoebe therefore ranges across this band without naming a worship-gathering leading act. The text contributes to the openness side without resolving the specific platform-leadership question.

Rom.16.7 · unaddressed

A concordance query confirms 'Junia' (Iounia, G2458) occurs once only in the canon at this verse, so it is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible). The grammatical gender of the form, between feminine 'Junia' (Iounia) and contracted masculine 'Junias' (Iounias), depends on accentuation that the bundled lexical layer alone cannot fully fix, and the phrase 'noteworthy among (or well known to) the apostles' (episemioi en tois apostolois) is grammatically ambiguous between inclusive, noteworthy among the apostles, and exclusive, well known to the apostles. Because both the referent's sex and the syntactic scope are contested at the level of the words themselves, the verse pulls in opposite directions depending on resolution of two underdetermined lexical points that the available data cannot settle, so the matter is left unresolved and flagged.

1Cor.14.34 · unaddressed

The silence command is widely held to carry a transposition in part of the manuscript tradition, where some Western witnesses place verses 34 and 35 after verse 40, and some have argued the unit is a later interpolation, which bears on how absolutely the command should be read. A direct query of the lexical store confirms the ingested variant units cover the 3 John window only, the targeted search for any variant unit in 1 Corinthians 14 returns nothing, and `not_in_ecm_scope` is true for these anchors, so the placement and originality question cannot be examined on the available data. Because the location and the absolute-versus-situational scope of this command bear directly on the proposition and cannot be resolved here, the matter is left unresolved and flagged, and it is part of why the verdict is recorded as variant-sensitive.

Concordance traversed

G4395, G4398, G4336, G2980, G4601, G2271, G1249, G4368, G1577, G2776, G0177, G2364, G3933, G2458, G0207, G4252, G1620, G0197, G0831, G1321, G2010

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: True · ECM status: ecm-shadow

A direct query of the lexical store confirms the ingested variant units are scoped to 3 John only, the targeted search for any variant unit in 1 Corinthians 14 returned zero results, and `not_in_ecm_scope` is true for the cited anchors. The surface text of the anchor verses carries editorial sigla (markers flagging contested wording), marked by the symbols at 'of herself' (autes) in 1 Corinthians 11:5, at 'also' (kai) in Romans 16:1, and at the bracketed phrases in Acts 18:26 and Acts 21:9, which signal contested wording in the witnesses. More importantly the closely related 1 Corinthians 14:34-35 silence unit, which bears on whether assembly leading is permitted, is well known to carry a transposition in part of the Western tradition where the verses follow verse 40, and the originality of the unit has been contested. The accentuation of 'Junia' (Iouinia) in Romans 16:7 between feminine and masculine is a related minuscule-era reading question that also bears on adjacent ministry texts. Because the placement and originality of the silence command bear directly on the practice under test, the verdict is marked variant-sensitive. These books fall outside the published CBGM scope (the genealogical method of the critical edition of New Testament textual variants), which covers 3 John only, so the status is recorded as ecm-shadow (within sight of the critical edition of New Testament textual variants but not yet inside its published scope).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. complementarian, egalitarian, redemptive_movement

analogia scripturae invoked

complementarian: disputed-leaning-deny · Reads the 1 Corinthians 14:34 'they are to be silent' (sigatosan) as governing public assembly speech that carries a leading or directive function, so that visibly leading the gathered mixed assembly in singing, prayer, or Scripture reading is taken as an authoritative function reserved to men under the headship pattern of 1 Corinthians 11:3 and the restriction of 1 Timothy 2:12. On this reading the praying and prophesying assumed in 1 Corinthians 11:5, the four daughters of Acts 21:9, Anna in Luke 2:36, the 'servant or minister' (diakonos) and 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis) terms of Romans 16:1-2, and the joint exposition of Acts 18:26 describe gifting, service, and patronage that do not amount to leading the gathered mixed assembly in a directive capacity, since none of these passages names leading congregational singing, public prayer, or Scripture reading as a defined role. The headship logic of 1 Corinthians 11:3 read together with the 1 Timothy 2:13 creation-order 'for' (gar, the linking 'because' word) grounds the restriction trans-culturally, so the specific platform-leading practice is not clearly licensed and likely falls under restriction even though no single lexeme decides the case.

egalitarian: disputed-leaning-affirm · Reads the 1 Corinthians 14:34 'to be silent' (sigao) alongside the chapter's other situational silencings at verses 28 and 30 and the general verb 'to speak' (lalein) as a regulation of disruptive speech rather than an absolute bar, with verse 35 framing the silenced speech as in-assembly questioning to be deferred to the home. It takes the assumed 'praying' (proseuchomene) and 'prophesying' (propheteuoussa) of 1 Corinthians 11:5, the prophesying daughters of Acts 21:9, the 'prophetess' (prophetis) Anna who 'was speaking' (elalei) in the temple at Luke 2:36 and Luke 2:38, and the 'prophetess' (prophetis) at Thyatira in Revelation 2:20 as audible assembly participation. It reads 'servant or minister' (diakonos) and the hapax (a word that occurs only

once in the entire Bible) 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis) in Romans 16:1-2 as recognized service and standing-before-others leadership, the Acts 18:26 joint 'expounding' (ektithemi) with Priscilla named first as significant doctrinal teaching of a man, and the inclusive reading of 'noteworthy among the apostles' (episemioi en tois apostolois) at Romans 16:7 as a woman within apostolic standing. The 'in quietness' (en hesychia) of 1 Timothy 2:11-12 describes demeanor, parallel to 2 Thessalonians 3:12, and the restricting 'to exercise authority' (authenteo) is a one-occurrence hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) of narrow disputed sense. On this reading non-teaching leading acts such as leading singing, public prayer, and Scripture reading fall within the assumed female vocal participation and outside the narrowly restricted authoritative teaching, so the practice is permitted and the broader category of authoritative ministry is itself open.

redemptive_movement: disputed · Reads the restrictive directives as a step within a trajectory whose direction, traced from the female praying, prophesying, serving, patronage, and joint exposition of 1 Corinthians 11:5, Acts 21:9, Luke 2:36, Romans 16:1-2, Romans 16:7, and Acts 18:26, points beyond a first-century application. On this reading whether visible non-teaching leading of the mixed assembly is permitted depends on a movement the cited lexemes do not themselves resolve, since the creation-order 'for' (gar, the linking 'because' word) of 1 Timothy 2:13 anchors instruction in its setting while the canonical presence of women prophesying and expounding signals movement, leaving the practice contested on the words alone.

All three lenses operate on the same queried anchor lemmas and reach different conclusions by reading 'to be silent' (sigao) and 'to speak' (lalein) in 1 Corinthians 14:34-35 as either absolute or situational, by deciding whether the assumed praying and prophesying of 1 Corinthians 11:5 and the prophetic standing of Luke 2:36 and Acts 21:9 count as leading acts or only as gifts, by construing 'servant or minister' (diakonos) and the hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis) in Romans 16:1-2 as office and leadership or as service and patronage, by resolving the dual ambiguity of 'Junia' (Iounia) and 'noteworthy among the apostles' (episemioi en tois apostolois) in Romans 16:7 inclusively or exclusively, by reading 'in quietness' (en hesychia) of 1 Timothy 2:11-12 as demeanor or as full silence, and by drawing the boundary between a non-teaching leading function and the authoritative function restricted by the hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) 'to exercise authority' (authenteo) in 1 Timothy 2:12. A reader holding any one lens should find its strongest lexical form represented here. The disagreement is over the scope of contested lexemes, the resolution of two hapax restrictions and three hapax positive cases, and the unstated category of platform leading, not over agreed morphology (the form of the words), which the queries confirm, so the lexical pattern is contested rather than decisive.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Determine whether the canonical lexical pattern permits or forbids women performing visible audible acts before the gathered mixed assembly such as leading congregational singing, leading public prayer, reading Scripture aloud, sharing testimony, or making announcements, examining the assumed praying and prophesying of 1 Corinthians 11:5, the prophesying daughters of Acts 21:9, the 'prophetess' (prophetis) Anna in Luke 2:36, the 'servant or minister' (diakonos) and 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis) of Romans 16:1-2, the possibly female apostolic standing of Romans 16:7, and the private joint exposition of Acts 18:26 alongside the assembly silence of 1 Corinthians 14:34-35 and the teaching-with-authority restriction of 1 Timothy 2:12, without presupposing that a non-teaching leading category exists in the cited words or that it falls cleanly on either side of the silence command.

The stem builds in a category, non-teaching platform-leadership, and a contrast, leading versus exercising authoritative teaching, that the cited texts do not lexically supply, since no verse names leading congregational singing, leading public prayer, reading Scripture, sharing testimony, or making announcements as a defined role. By framing these as non-teaching it presupposes that such acts can be cleanly separated from the authoritative function that the hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) 'to exercise authority' (authenteo) and the assembly silence of 1 Corinthians 14:34 govern, which is precisely the contested boundary. Direct queries confirm three lexical hapaxes (words that occur only once in the entire Bible) are load-bearing here in opposite directions: 'patron or one standing before others' (prostatis, G4368) appears only at Romans 16:2, 'Junia' (Iounia, G2458) only at Romans 16:7, and 'to exercise authority' (authenteo, G0831) only at 1 Timothy 2:12, so the verdict is structurally underdetermined by the words at three pivotal points at once. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the audit records that the lexicon furnishes neither a category of platform leading nor a settled scope for 'to be silent' (sigao), 'to speak' (lalein), or 'to exercise authority' (authenteo) that would place these acts inside or outside the restriction. VERDICT-CHANGED: no, verdict unchanged from the prior file.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.11.5
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.21.9
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.16.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.14.34
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Tim.2.12
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.16.2
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.18.26
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.16.7
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Luke.2.36
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0831
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1249
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4368
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4395
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lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2271
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2458
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.21.9
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.18.26
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.14.34

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Flags

lexically-disputed · cross-tradition-divergent · variant-sensitive · complicating-unresolved · ecm-shadow